

LIT4114 Adaptations of Literature

College of Arts and Humanities

Department of English

Course Information

Term: Spring 2028

Class Meeting Days: MW

Class Meeting Time: 3:00PM - 4:15PM

Credit Hours: 3.00

Course Description

This course studies how the written word is adapted to the screen as well as the cultural and historical aspects of adaptation. We will identify adaptation as a form of representation and rewriting, especially including cinematic adaptations of significant events in history and examining their impacts on viewers in the present day. In addition, we will examine challenges to the conventional treatment of adaptation that often privileges literature over film. This course dissects a mix of classic literature as well as contemporary works that are more relevant to the students' current world. In the selected literature and its filmic versions in the course, we will explore how intertextuality plays out in the two mediums, sometimes three, and in what ways the films present different frames of representation or in some cases, misrepresentation.

Students taking this course are diving deeper into their literature-focused degrees and are interested in the art of film as a way to express stories as well as the cultural and historical context that coincides with this. Students in this class are also leaning into the film industry, contributing perspectives on how written content becomes adaptable for stage or screen based on a variety of aspects. Responses to these texts, close viewing and reading of the texts will be essential components of this class.

Course Objectives

After successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- Understand and demonstrate knowledge of major adaptation theories and engage with them critically.
- Analyze how literary texts are reworked for visual media, with particular attention to representation and form.
- Explore intertextuality and how this concept plays out between adaptations and its original source material.
 - This will involve analyzing ways the films present different frames of representation or misrepresentation.
- Examine how historical contexts, periods, and cultural trends shape the translation of literature into film adaptations.
 - This will be done through exploring different types of established adaptations throughout the years and if/how they have deviated from the original source material.
 - The focus is on challenging the conventional opinion toward adaptation that suggests literature is better than film and how the industry responds to this.

Course Materials

- *Film and Literature: An Introduction and Reader*
Author: Timothy Corrigan
Publication Date: 2012
Edition: 2nd
- *Pride and Prejudice*
Author: Jane Austen
Publication Date: 1813
- *Wuthering Heights*
Author: Emily Bronte
Publication Date: 1837
- *As You Like It, Twelfth Night, A Midsummer Night's Dream, Romeo and Juliet*
Author: William Shakespeare
Edition: 3rd Edition
- *The Great Gatsby*
Author: F. Scott Fitzgerald
Publication Date: 1925
- *The Odyssey*
Author: Homer
Edition: Robert Fagles, 1996
- *The Outsiders*
Author: S. E. Hinton
Publication Date: 1967

Assignment Overview & Grading Procedure

- Adaptation Exploration:
 - Students will read and respond to 6 different works throughout the 16 weeks comparing and contrasting the differences and similarities displayed, and will examine the historical/cultural significance. Excerpts/Chapters necessary will be provided, however, students are welcome to read the full text; same for the films/productions listed.
- Discussion Boards:
 - Discussions will be students' personal thoughts on the examples of the given literature and their various adaptations, while keeping in mind the theories and implementations throughout.
- Final Project Conception Response Paper:
 - Students will start to think about what piece of literature they want to adapt and how they would do it. This is a 1 page paper expressing if they are creating their own adaptation or reimagining one that already exists and what specific theories of adaptation they would apply.
- Digital Storyline Draft:
 - To prepare for the final project, students will develop an adaptation outline for a film or stage production of any piece of literature that doesn't already exist OR reimagining an already existing adaptation. This assignment requires the AI-assisted interactive template that guides students on the different elements and theories of their adaptation.
- Final Project Proposal:
 - A quality project proposal including the Digital Storyline of the adaptation they developed. This is a 2,000 word reflective essay that includes: examining the concept of rewriting something for the present moment, acknowledging any cultural perspective and historical representation that relates to the context of the adaptation, detailing how they will align the content of the story with a new interpretation including, but limited to: visuals, music, imagery, and symbolism.
 - AI-created Study Guide & Visual Interactive Explorer tool will be used throughout the final project process to encourage exposure with agentic tools and to help guide brainstorming, organization, and comparative theories.

Points	Assignment Summary	Due
15%	Discussion Posts - Discussions surround adaptation exploration and the adaptation theories applied. Student's personal opinions and experiences are essential for these discussions. *No discussion posts are due in weeks when major assignments are due.	Bi-Weekly
20%	Response Paper - 1 page response paper reflective of the beginning brainstorm process for the final project. Students are choosing what piece of literature they will adapt and how OR reimagining an adaptation that already exists and why.	Week 6
20%	Final Project Digital Storyline Draft - Use of AI-created Digital Storyline Template to draft the outline of the adaptation. Students are graded on their participation with AI as well as the content included in their digital storyline draft.	Week 11
35%	Final Project - Final Digital Storyline template completed and 2,000 word reflective essay explaining what their adaptation is based on, what has been kept and changed from the original source material, why these changes were made, and any extra elements added to enhance their adaptation for a visual audience.	Week 16
10%	AI Participation - This class integrates AI-assisted tools for certain assignments and brainstorming activities to encourage experience with AI. Students will use these tools to draft ideas, produce summaries, and analyze themes and connections. While students are using their own thought processes, they are graded on participating and willingness to interact with AI.	Weeks 6-16

Grading Scale

A+ 95-100 A- 90-94

B+ 87-89 B 84-86 B- 80-83

C+ 77-79 C 74-76 C- 70-73

D+ 67-69 D 64-66 D- 60-63

F 59 and below

Missed/Late Assignments

Late work is accepted for one week after the listed deadline, otherwise, missing assignments will result in point value deducted from final grade.

Class Schedule

Week	Topic	Assigned Reading(s)
1	Introduction to Course and Syllabus discussion. Introduction” from Corrigan What is an Adaptation? What is Intertextuality?	• <i>Film and Literature: An Introduction and Reader</i> Author: Timothy Corrigan • Discussion: What is Your Favorite Adaptation?
2	Classic Adaptations- Pride & Prejudice	• Read Chapters 34-35, 58 <i>Pride and Prejudice</i> Author: Jane Austen • Watch <i>Pride and Prejudice</i> (2005)
3	Discuss Film and Text	• <i>Pride and Prejudice</i> Author: Jane Austen • Discussion: Compare & Contrast
4	Stage & Screen- Adapting for Theatrical Productions	• Read Chapter 11, 12 <i>The Outsiders</i> Author: S. E. Hinton • Watch <i>The Outsiders</i> (1983)
5	Discuss Stage, Screen, & Text	• Watch Clips of The Outsiders Broadway Production (2024) • Discussion: Compare & Contrast

6	Exploring Adaptation Theories- Fidelity Conceptualize Final Project & Experimenting with Visual Interactive Explorer	• <i>Film and Literature: An Introduction and Reader</i> Author: Timothy Corrigan • AI Visual Interactive Explorer • 1 Page Response Paper: What Do You Want to See Adapted & How Would You Do It?
7	Shakespeare in Adaptations	• Excerpts from <i>As You Like It, Twelfth Night, A Midsummer Night's Dream, Romeo & Juliet</i> Author: William Shakespeare
8	Shakespeare in Adaptations	• Discussion: Different Adaptations of Shakespeare's Plays and Which is most similar to original text?
9	Spectacle Adaptations- The Great Gatsby	• Read Chapters 1, 4, 6, 7 <i>The Great Gatsby</i> Author: F. Scott Fitzgerald • Watch <i>The Great Gatsby</i> (2013)
10	Discuss Text & Stage Version	• <i>The Great Gatsby</i> Author: F. Scott Fitzgerald • Watch clips of Broadway Production • Discussion: Compare & Contrast
11	Final Project First Draft Outline & Exploring with AI Study Guide	• Draft your outline of what adaptation you are creating with AI Digital Storyline • AI Study Guide App

12	Imagery & Aesthetics- Wuthering Heights	• Read Chapters 10-11, 18-34) <i>Wuthering Heights</i> Author: Emily Bronte • Watch Wuthering Heights (1939 & 2026)
13	Discuss Alternate Adaptations- Wuthering Heights	• Discussion Compare & Contrast
14	Language & Translations-The Odyssey	• Read Book 5 from <i>The Odyssey</i> Author: Homer • Watch <i>The Odyssey</i> (2026)
15	Discuss Modern Adaptations-The Odyssey	• Discussion Compare & Contrast
16	Final Project	

AI Policy

Because this course relies heavily on the student perspective, AI tools should be used intentionally and critically. There are agentic tools created specifically for this course that will be integrated in the assignments. However, when using these tools, remember AI is an assistant to your own thoughts, not a replacement for your voice.

The AI tools integrated in the course are the Study Guide application for textual analysis and critical prompting, and the Digital Storyline template that maps students' final project outline. Students will use these tools to draft ideas, produce summaries, break down readings, or experiment with putting complex concepts into their own words. There are exercises built into the course that are meant to guide students through the assignments and to enhance the creativity of the course. There will be step by step written instructions as well as demonstrative workshops for using these tools so that students are equally educated on AI usage here.

This policy does allow for experimentation through the UDL principals for engagement as well as action and expression. Assignments are structured so that students have ease of expression though these tools when required, while also allowing them space to express themselves unassisted if they so choose. (Assignments that require AI tools will be specified; they are intended to help students gain experience using AI). Unless otherwise listed, students are encouraged to use their own thought processes instead of AI assistance.

Always trust what you know about the topic to guide your inquiries; do not let the sheer volume of AI-generated options override your own analytical choices. Ultimately, remember that AI makes mistakes, therefore, you must always verify any output before proceeding to use the findings for your research.

In regards to copyright, be mindful of data ownership and intellectual property; AI-generated text cannot be claimed as your own original authorship. Be aware of the undercompensated human data laboring system AI relies on. Use these tools mindfully, acknowledging the human effort behind the algorithms.